While you wait for CloudFormation to create the stack, you will learn more about the details. To configure autoscaling, you need to create the following two parts of the configuration:

- A *launch template* contains all information needed to launch an EC2 instance: instance type (size of virtual machine) and image (AMI) to start from.
- An *Auto Scaling group* tells the EC2 service how many virtual machines should be started with a specific launch template, how to monitor the instances, and in which subnets EC2 instances should be started.

Figure 13.4 illustrates this process.

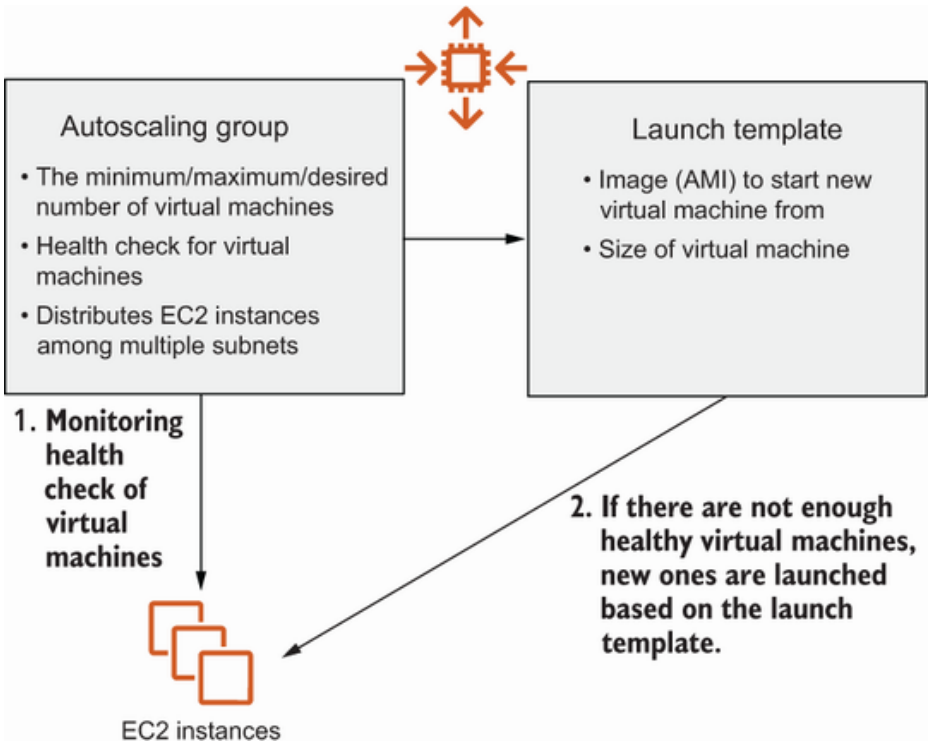


Figure 13.4 Autoscaling ensures that a specified number of EC2 instances are running.

You'll find both a launch template and an Auto Scaling group in the CloudFormation template for launching a Jenkins server, as shown in the next listing. The parameters are explained in table 13.1. You have already used the